Ubuntu Server 24.04 LTS (Noble Numbat) — Complete Command Reference

---

Table of Contents

- System Information & Hardware
- Package Management (APT)
- Snap Packages
- Flatpak
- Users & Groups
- Permissions & Ownership
- Systemd & Services
- Networking
- Firewall (UFW)
- Disk & Storage
- Logs & Journald
- Cron & Scheduled Tasks
- Security & Hardening
- Containers (Docker & Podman)
- Kernel & Modules
- Boot & GRUB
- Performance & Monitoring
- Backup & Restore
- Miscellaneous Useful Commands

System Information & Hardware

```
hostnamectl                          # Show hostname, OS, kernel, architecture
hostnamectl set-hostname new-name    # Change hostname
uname -a                             # Kernel version and system info
uname -r                             # Kernel release only
cat /etc/os-release                  # OS identification
lsb_release -a                       # Distribution info (Ubuntu)
uptime                               # How long system has been running
uptime -p                            # Pretty uptime
whoami                               # Current user
id                                   # User ID, group ID, and groups
w                                    # Who is logged in and what they're doing
who                                  # Who is logged in
last                                 # Login history
last reboot                          # Reboot history
```

```
lscpu                                # CPU architecture info
cat /proc/cpuinfo                    # Detailed CPU info
nproc                                # Number of processing units
free -h                              # Memory usage (human-readable)
cat /proc/meminfo                    # Detailed memory info
lsblk                                # Block devices (disks, partitions)
lsblk -f                             # Block devices with filesystem info
blkid                                # Block device UUIDs and types
fdisk -l                             # List all disk partitions
df -h                                # Disk space usage (human-readable)
df -i                                # Inode usage
du -sh /path/to/dir                  # Size of a directory
du -sh * | sort -rh                  # Sizes of all items, sorted
```

```
lspci                                # PCI devices
lspci -v                             # Verbose PCI devices
lsusb                                # USB devices
lsusb -v                             # Verbose USB devices
lshw -short                          # Hardware summary
lshw -class network                  # Network hardware only
dmidecode -t system                  # System manufacturer and model
dmidecode -t memory                  # Memory module details
dmidecode -t bios                    # BIOS version info
```

Package Management (APT)

```
apt update                           # Refresh package lists
apt upgrade                          # Upgrade all installed packages
apt full-upgrade                     # Upgrade, removing packages if needed
apt install package-name             # Install a package
apt install -y package-name          # Install without confirmation prompt
apt remove package-name              # Remove a package (keep config files)
apt purge package-name               # Remove a package and its config files
apt autoremove                       # Remove unused dependencies
apt autoremove --purge               # Remove unused deps and their configs
apt search keyword                   # Search for packages
apt show package-name                # Show package details
apt list --installed                 # List all installed packages
apt list --upgradable                # List packages with updates available
apt-mark hold package-name           # Prevent package from being upgraded
apt-mark unhold package-name         # Allow package to be upgraded again
apt-mark showhold                    # List held packages
```

```
dpkg -i package.deb                  # Install a local .deb file
dpkg -l                              # List all installed packages
dpkg -l | grep keyword               # Search installed packages
dpkg -L package-name                 # List files installed by a package
dpkg -S /path/to/file                # Find which package owns a file
dpkg --configure -a                  # Reconfigure all unconfigured packages
```

```
add-apt-repository ppa:user/ppa-name # Add a PPA repository
add-apt-repository --remove ppa:user/ppa-name  # Remove a PPA
```

Snap Packages

```
snap list                            # List installed snaps
snap find keyword                    # Search for snaps
snap info package-name               # Show snap details
snap install package-name            # Install a snap
snap install --classic package-name  # Install with classic confinement
snap remove package-name             # Remove a snap
snap refresh                         # Update all snaps
snap refresh package-name            # Update a specific snap
snap revert package-name             # Revert to previous version
snap disable package-name            # Disable a snap
snap enable package-name             # Enable a snap
```

Flatpak

```
flatpak list                         # List installed flatpaks
flatpak search keyword               # Search for flatpaks
flatpak install flathub app-id       # Install from Flathub
flatpak uninstall app-id             # Remove a flatpak
flatpak update                       # Update all flatpaks
flatpak run app-id                   # Run a flatpak
```

Users & Groups

```
adduser username                     # Create a user (interactive)
useradd -m -s /bin/bash username     # Create user with home dir and bash shell
usermod -aG sudo username            # Add user to sudo group
usermod -aG groupname username       # Add user to a group
usermod -L username                  # Lock user account
usermod -U username                  # Unlock user account
usermod -s /bin/bash username        # Change user's shell
deluser username                     # Remove user
deluser --remove-home username       # Remove user and home directory
passwd username                      # Change user password
passwd -e username                   # Force password change on next login
chage -l username                    # Show password aging info
```

```
groupadd groupname                   # Create a group
groupdel groupname                   # Delete a group
gpasswd -a username groupname        # Add user to group
gpasswd -d username groupname        # Remove user from group
groups username                      # Show groups for user
```

```
cat /etc/passwd                      # List all users
cat /etc/group                       # List all groups
cat /etc/shadow                      # Password hashes (root only)
```

Permissions & Ownership

```
chmod 755 file                       # rwxr-xr-x
chmod 644 file                       # rw-r--r--
chmod 600 file                       # rw-------
chmod +x file                        # Add execute for all
chmod -R 755 directory               # Recursive permissions
chown user:group file                # Change owner and group
chown -R user:group directory        # Recursive ownership change
chgrp groupname file                 # Change group only
```

```
umask                                # Show default permission mask
umask 022                            # Set default mask (files: 644, dirs: 755)
```

```
getfacl file                         # Show ACL permissions
setfacl -m u:username:rwx file       # Grant user ACL permissions
setfacl -m g:groupname:rx file       # Grant group ACL permissions
setfacl -x u:username file           # Remove user ACL
```

Systemd & Services

```
systemctl start service              # Start a service
systemctl stop service               # Stop a service
systemctl restart service            # Restart a service
systemctl reload service             # Reload config without restart
systemctl status service             # Show service status
systemctl enable service             # Enable service at boot
systemctl disable service            # Disable service at boot
systemctl enable --now service       # Enable and start immediately
systemctl is-active service          # Check if service is running
systemctl is-enabled service         # Check if service is enabled
systemctl is-failed service          # Check if service has failed
```

```
systemctl list-units                 # List all active units
systemctl list-units --type=service  # List active services
systemctl list-units --failed        # List failed units
systemctl list-unit-files            # List all unit files and their state
systemctl daemon-reload              # Reload systemd manager config
systemctl mask service               # Prevent service from being started
systemctl unmask service             # Allow service to be started again
```

```
systemctl poweroff                   # Shut down
systemctl reboot                     # Reboot
systemctl suspend                    # Suspend
systemctl hibernate                  # Hibernate
systemctl rescue                     # Enter rescue mode
systemctl isolate multi-user.target  # Switch to multi-user (no GUI)
systemctl isolate graphical.target   # Switch to graphical mode
```

Networking

```
ip addr                              # Show all IP addresses
ip addr show eth0                    # Show IP for specific interface
ip addr add 192.168.1.10/24 dev eth0 # Add IP address to interface
ip addr del 192.168.1.10/24 dev eth0 # Remove IP address from interface
ip link                              # List network interfaces
ip link set eth0 up                  # Bring interface up
ip link set eth0 down                # Bring interface down
ip route                             # Show routing table
ip route add default via 192.168.1.1 # Add default gateway
ip route del default                 # Remove default gateway
```

```
ping -c 4 host                       # Ping 4 times
traceroute host                      # Trace route to host
mtr host                             # Combined ping and traceroute
dig domain                           # DNS lookup
dig +short domain                    # Short DNS answer
dig -x 192.168.1.1                   # Reverse DNS lookup
nslookup domain                      # DNS lookup (alternative)
host domain                          # Simple DNS lookup
```

```
ss -tulnp                            # Show listening ports (TCP/UDP)
ss -tnp                              # Show established TCP connections
ss -s                                # Socket statistics summary
netstat -tulnp                       # Listening ports (legacy)
curl -I https://example.com          # Fetch HTTP headers
curl -O https://example.com/file     # Download file
wget https://example.com/file        # Download file
wget -c https://example.com/file     # Resume interrupted download
```

```
nmcli device status                  # Show device status
nmcli connection show                # List connections
nmcli connection up name             # Activate connection
nmcli connection down name           # Deactivate connection
nmcli device wifi list               # List WiFi networks
nmcli device wifi connect SSID password pass  # Connect to WiFi
```

Firewall (UFW)

```
ufw status                           # Show firewall status
ufw status verbose                   # Detailed status
ufw enable                           # Enable firewall
ufw disable                          # Disable firewall
ufw allow 22                         # Allow port 22
ufw allow 22/tcp                     # Allow port 22 TCP only
ufw allow from 192.168.1.0/24        # Allow subnet
ufw deny 80                          # Deny port 80
ufw delete allow 22                  # Remove allow rule
ufw allow ssh                        # Allow SSH by service name
ufw reset                            # Reset all rules
```

Disk & Storage

```
mount /dev/sdb1 /mnt/point           # Mount a partition
umount /mnt/point                    # Unmount
mount -a                             # Mount all entries in /etc/fstab
```

```
fdisk /dev/sdb                       # Partition a disk (interactive)
mkfs.ext4 /dev/sdb1                  # Format as ext4
mkfs.xfs /dev/sdb1                   # Format as XFS
mkfs.vfat /dev/sdb1                  # Format as FAT32
```

```
pvcreate /dev/sdb1                   # Create LVM physical volume
vgcreate vg-name /dev/sdb1           # Create volume group
lvcreate -L 10G -n lv-name vg-name   # Create logical volume
lvextend -L +5G /dev/vg-name/lv-name # Extend logical volume
resize2fs /dev/vg-name/lv-name       # Resize ext4 filesystem
pvs                                  # List physical volumes
vgs                                  # List volume groups
lvs                                  # List logical volumes
```

```
swapon --show                        # Show swap usage
swapon /dev/sdb2                     # Enable swap partition
swapoff /dev/sdb2                    # Disable swap partition
```

Logs & Journald

```
journalctl                           # View all logs
journalctl -f                        # Follow logs in real time
journalctl -u service                # Logs for a specific service
journalctl -u service --since today  # Service logs since today
journalctl --since "2024-01-01"      # Logs since a date
journalctl --until "1 hour ago"      # Logs until 1 hour ago
journalctl -p err                    # Only error-level logs
journalctl -b                        # Logs from current boot
journalctl -b -1                     # Logs from previous boot
journalctl --disk-usage              # Show journal disk usage
journalctl --vacuum-size=500M        # Trim journal to 500MB
journalctl --vacuum-time=2weeks      # Trim journal older than 2 weeks
```

```
tail -f /var/log/syslog              # Follow syslog
tail -f /var/log/auth.log            # Follow auth log
tail -f /var/log/kern.log            # Follow kernel log
grep "pattern" /var/log/syslog       # Search log for pattern
```

Cron & Scheduled Tasks

```
crontab -e                           # Edit current user's crontab
crontab -l                           # List current user's crontab
crontab -r                           # Remove current user's crontab
crontab -u username -e               # Edit another user's crontab
```

```
# Cron format:
# * * * * * command
# | | | | |
# | | | | +-- Day of week (0-7, Sun=0 or 7)
# | | | +---- Month (1-12)
# | | +------ Day of month (1-31)
# | +-------- Hour (0-23)
# +---------- Minute (0-59)
```

```
/etc/cron.d/                         # System cron jobs
/etc/cron.daily/                     # Scripts run daily
/etc/cron.hourly/                    # Scripts run hourly
/etc/cron.weekly/                    # Scripts run weekly
/etc/cron.monthly/                   # Scripts run monthly
```

Security & Hardening

```
ufw enable                           # Enable firewall
fail2ban-client status               # Check fail2ban status
fail2ban-client status sshd          # Check SSH jail status
```

```
ssh-keygen -t ed25519                # Generate SSH key pair
ssh-keygen -t rsa -b 4096            # Generate RSA key pair
ssh-copy-id user@host                # Copy public key to server
```

```
/etc/ssh/sshd_config                 # SSH server configuration
/etc/ssh/ssh_config                  # SSH client configuration
```

```
# Common sshd_config hardening:
PermitRootLogin no
PasswordAuthentication no
PubkeyAuthentication yes
Port 2222
AllowUsers username
```

```
systemctl restart sshd               # Restart SSH after config changes
```

```
aa-status                            # AppArmor status
aa-enforce /etc/apparmor.d/profile   # Enforce AppArmor profile
aa-complain /etc/apparmor.d/profile  # Set profile to complain mode
```

```
unattended-upgrades --dry-run        # Test automatic updates
dpkg-reconfigure unattended-upgrades # Configure automatic updates
```

Containers (Docker & Podman)

```
docker ps                            # List running containers
docker ps -a                         # List all containers
docker images                        # List images
docker pull image                    # Pull an image
docker run -d --name name image      # Run container in background
docker run -it image /bin/bash       # Run container interactively
docker stop container                # Stop a container
docker start container               # Start a stopped container
docker rm container                  # Remove a container
docker rmi image                     # Remove an image
docker exec -it container /bin/bash  # Shell into running container
docker logs container                # View container logs
docker logs -f container             # Follow container logs
docker compose up -d                 # Start compose stack
docker compose down                  # Stop compose stack
docker compose ps                    # List compose containers
docker system prune -a               # Remove all unused data
```

```
podman ps                            # List running containers
podman images                        # List images
podman pull image                    # Pull an image
podman run -d --name name image      # Run container in background
podman stop container                # Stop a container
podman rm container                  # Remove a container
podman exec -it container /bin/bash  # Shell into running container
podman logs container                # View container logs
```

Kernel & Modules

```
uname -r                             # Current kernel version
dpkg -l | grep linux-image           # List installed kernels
apt install linux-image-generic      # Install latest kernel
apt remove linux-image-x.x.x-xx      # Remove old kernel
```

```
lsmod                                # List loaded modules
modinfo module-name                  # Show module info
modprobe module-name                 # Load a module
modprobe -r module-name              # Unload a module
```

```
/etc/modules                         # Modules loaded at boot
/etc/modprobe.d/                     # Module configuration files
```

Boot & GRUB

```
update-grub                          # Regenerate GRUB config
grub-install /dev/sda                # Install GRUB to disk
```

```
/etc/default/grub                    # GRUB configuration
/boot/grub/grub.cfg                  # Generated GRUB config (do not edit)
```

```
# Common GRUB_CMDLINE_LINUX_DEFAULT options:
quiet                                # Suppress boot messages
splash                               # Show splash screen
nomodeset                            # Disable kernel mode setting
```

Performance & Monitoring

```
top                                  # Process monitor
htop                                 # Interactive process monitor
btop                                 # Resource monitor
iotop                                # I/O usage by process
iotop -o                             # Only show processes doing I/O
vmstat 1                             # Virtual memory stats every 1 second
iostat -x 1                          # Extended I/O stats every 1 second
sar -u 1 3                           # CPU usage, 3 samples 1 second apart
```

```
ps aux                               # All running processes
ps aux --sort=-%mem                  # Processes sorted by memory usage
ps aux --sort=-%cpu                  # Processes sorted by CPU usage
pgrep name                           # Find PID by name
pkill name                           # Kill process by name
kill -9 PID                          # Force kill process
kill -15 PID                         # Graceful kill process
```

```
nice -n 10 command                   # Run with lower priority
renice -n 10 -p PID                  # Change priority of running process
```

Backup & Restore

```
tar -czvf archive.tar.gz /path       # Create gzip archive
tar -xzvf archive.tar.gz             # Extract gzip archive
tar -cjvf archive.tar.bz2 /path      # Create bzip2 archive
tar -xjvf archive.tar.bz2            # Extract bzip2 archive
tar -tvf archive.tar.gz              # List contents without extracting
```

```
rsync -avz source/ dest/             # Sync directories
rsync -avz --delete source/ dest/    # Sync and delete removed files
rsync -avz -e ssh source/ user@host:/dest/  # Sync over SSH
```

```
dd if=/dev/sda of=/dev/sdb bs=4M     # Clone disk
dd if=/dev/sda of=image.img bs=4M    # Create disk image
```

Miscellaneous Useful Commands

```
screen                               # Start a screen session
screen -r                            # Reattach to screen session
screen -ls                           # List screen sessions
tmux                                 # Start a tmux session
tmux attach                          # Reattach to tmux session
tmux ls                              # List tmux sessions
```

```
watch -n 2 command                   # Run command every 2 seconds
time command                         # Measure command execution time
yes | command                        # Auto-answer yes to prompts
```

```
sudo !!                              # Run last command as sudo
!$                                   # Last argument of previous command
!!:s/old/new/                       # Replace in previous command
```

```
alias ll='ls -la'                    # Create alias
unalias ll                           # Remove alias
```

```
/etc/profile                         # System-wide environment variables
~/.bashrc                            # User bash configuration
~/.bash_aliases                      # User aliases
```

Ubuntu Server 24.04 LTS (Noble Numbat) — Complete Command Reference